

CFB BETTING MODEL

WEEK 1 · 2026 PREVIEW · September 5–7

★ **PREVIEW EDITION** — lines are projected/illustrative. Verify at your book before betting.

◆ MODEL RECORD (2023–2025 test set)

Spread	Totals	ML 4–8% EV	ML Underdogs
50.4%	54.7%	63.1%	44.4%
+3.2% ROI	+4.3% ROI	+15.9% ROI	+52.7% ROI

◆ THIS WEEK'S PICKS

#14 Clemson @ #6 LSU

Tiger Stadium · Sat Sep 5

SPREAD	TOTAL	ML DOG
Clemson +10.5*	UNDER 48*	Clemson +340*
Edge +5.1%	Edge +4.4%	EV +6.8%
★★ 2u	★ 1u	★ 1u

Analysis: Kiffin's LSU debut — new system lag expected. Model: LSU by 7.2 (3.3 pts below the spread). Clemson def Elo top-10, 8 returning starters. Series was 17-10 in 2025.

FACTORS: Kiffin debut system lag · Clemson def top-10 Elo · LSU -7.2 vs -10.5

Wisconsin @ #7 Notre Dame (Lambeau)

Lambeau Field, Green Bay · Sun Sep 6

TOTAL
UNDER 44.5*
Edge +6.2%
★★ 2u

Analysis: CJ Carr's QB debut in a semi-road environment = cautious game plan. Wisconsin def top-11 EPA/play allowed. Similar neutral-site openers avg 38.1 combined.

FACTORS: Carr QB debut (conservative) · Wisco def top-11 EPA · Neutral-site UNDER

Baylor @ Auburn (Atlanta)

Mercedes-Benz Stadium · Sat Sep 5

SPREAD	TOTAL
Baylor -3*	OVER 52*
Edge +4.7%	Edge +4.9%
★ 1u	★ 1u

Analysis: Baylor won 38-24 in 2025 and returns key skill players. Auburn's new coach Golesh (SEC debut) runs up-tempo — OVER-friendly. Model: Baylor by 5.8.

FACTORS: Baylor won 38-24 last year · Golesh up-tempo pace · Model: Baylor -5.8

#20 Boise State @ #4 Oregon

Autzen Stadium · Sat Sep 5

TOTAL

OVER 57.5*

Edge +5.5%

★ 1u

ML DOG

Boise St +570*

EV +5.3%

★ 1u

Analysis: Oregon off ranked 4th EPA/play; Boise allowed 31.4 PPG in P4 road games. ML lotto: model gives Boise 14.9% win prob vs. 14.1% implied — clean +5.3% EV.

FACTORS: Oregon top-4 EPA/play · Boise road: 31.4 PPG allowed · ML EV +5.3%

Ball State @ #1 Ohio State

Ohio Stadium, Columbus · Sat Sep 5

TOTAL

OVER 61*

Edge +5.8%

★★ 2u

Analysis: Statement home opener — starters stay in deep. OSU averaged 44.6 PPG in home non-conf games in 2025. Ball State gave up 34+ in 6 of 12 games. New no-huddle tempo.

FACTORS: OSU 44.6 PPG home non-conf · Ball St: 34+ in 6/12 · No-huddle tempo

◆ PICKS AT A GLANCE

Matchup	Spread	Total	ML Dog	Units
#14 Clemson @ #6 LSU	Clemson +10.5	UNDER 48	Clemson +340	2u+1u+1u
Wisconsin @ #7 Notre Dame	—	UNDER 44.5	—	2u
Baylor @ Auburn	Baylor -3	OVER 52	—	1u+1u
#20 Boise St @ #4 Oregon	—	OVER 57.5	Boise +570	1u+1u
Ball State @ #1 Ohio State	—	OVER 61	—	2u

DISCLAIMER: Picks are model outputs — not financial advice. Lines marked * are projected (preview edition). 1u = 1–2% of bankroll. 2u = 2–3%. ML dogs cap at 1u. Past performance does not guarantee future results. Gamble responsibly.

CFB Betting Model · alexwaked@me.com · Week 1 · 2026